

From a private question to neighborhood action

Nextdoor is most valuable when the information a user needs lives with nearby people. But finding information and asking identifiable neighbors for it are not the same behavior.

TARGET BEHAVIOR

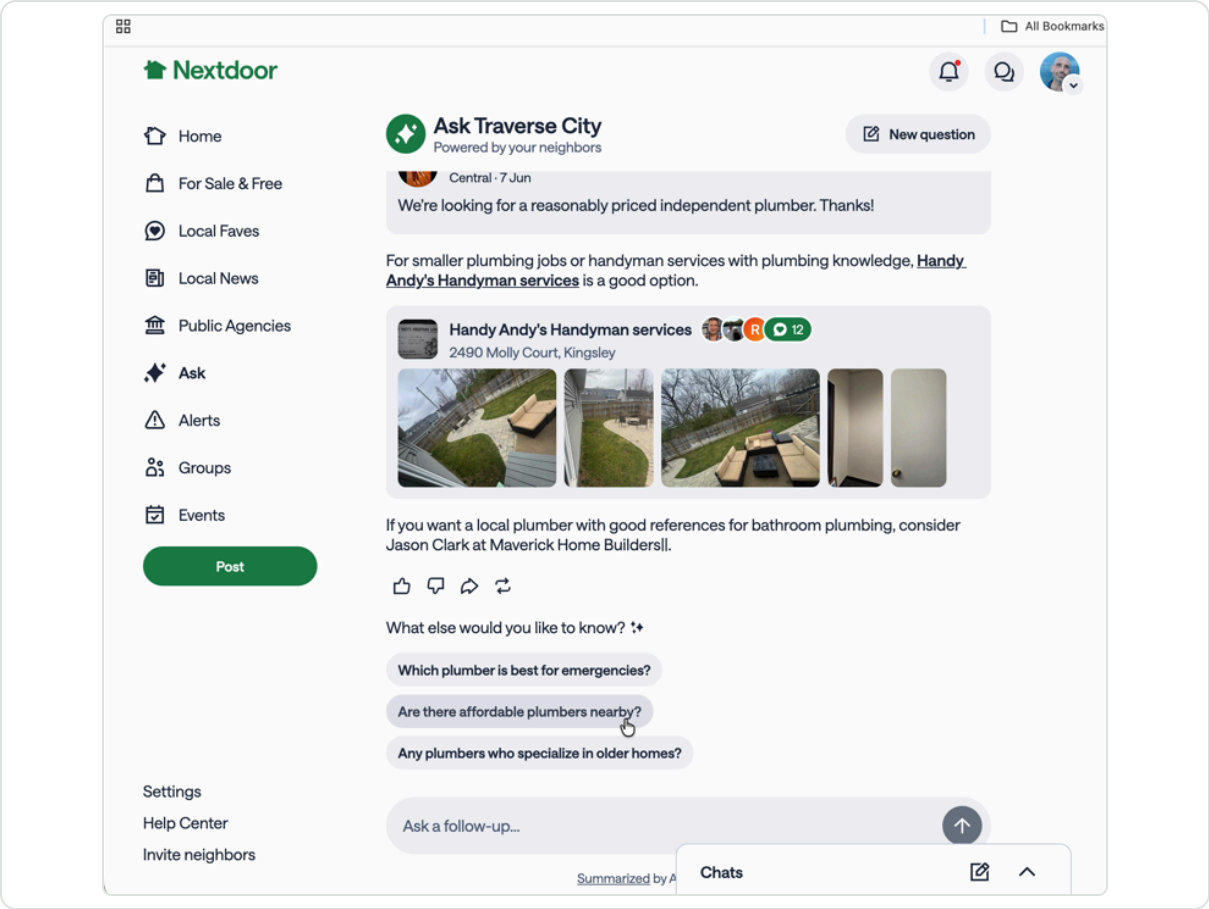
Publish a neighborhood request when existing local information does not resolve the user's need.



The last step changes the task from private inquiry to public action.

OBSERVATION

Ask already does most of the hard informational work

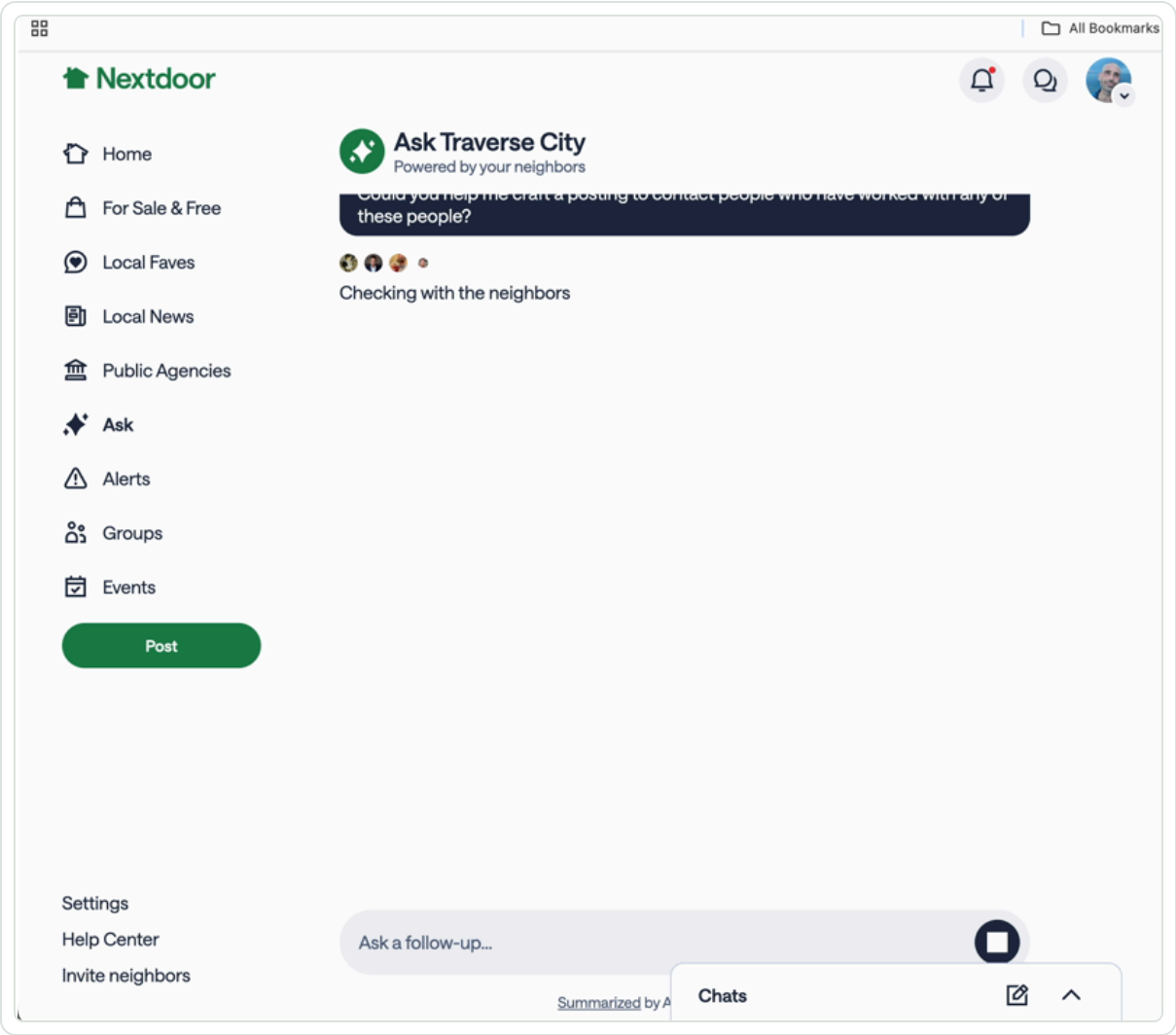


CURRENT EXPERIENCE

I asked Nextdoor for help finding a plumber. Ask understood the local need, surfaced relevant providers, retained the conversational context, and offered ways to narrow the decision.

At that point, the remaining uncertainty was no longer **“Which plumbers exist?”** It was **“What have my neighbors actually experienced with these providers?”**

OBSERVATION · STATE A

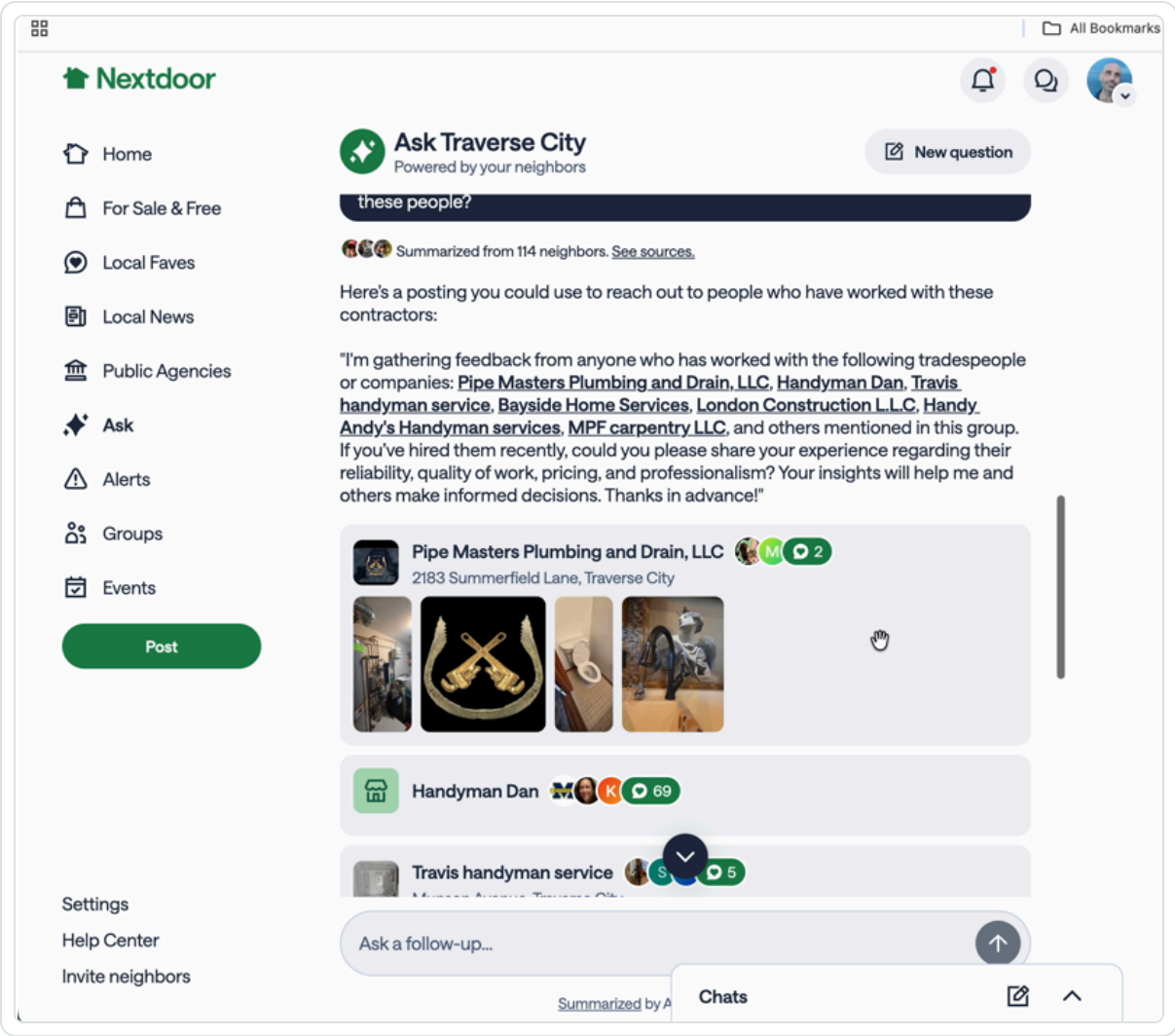


CURRENT EXPERIENCE

Intent becomes explicit.

I ask Ask to help me contact people who have worked with the providers already in the conversation.

OBSERVATION · STATE B

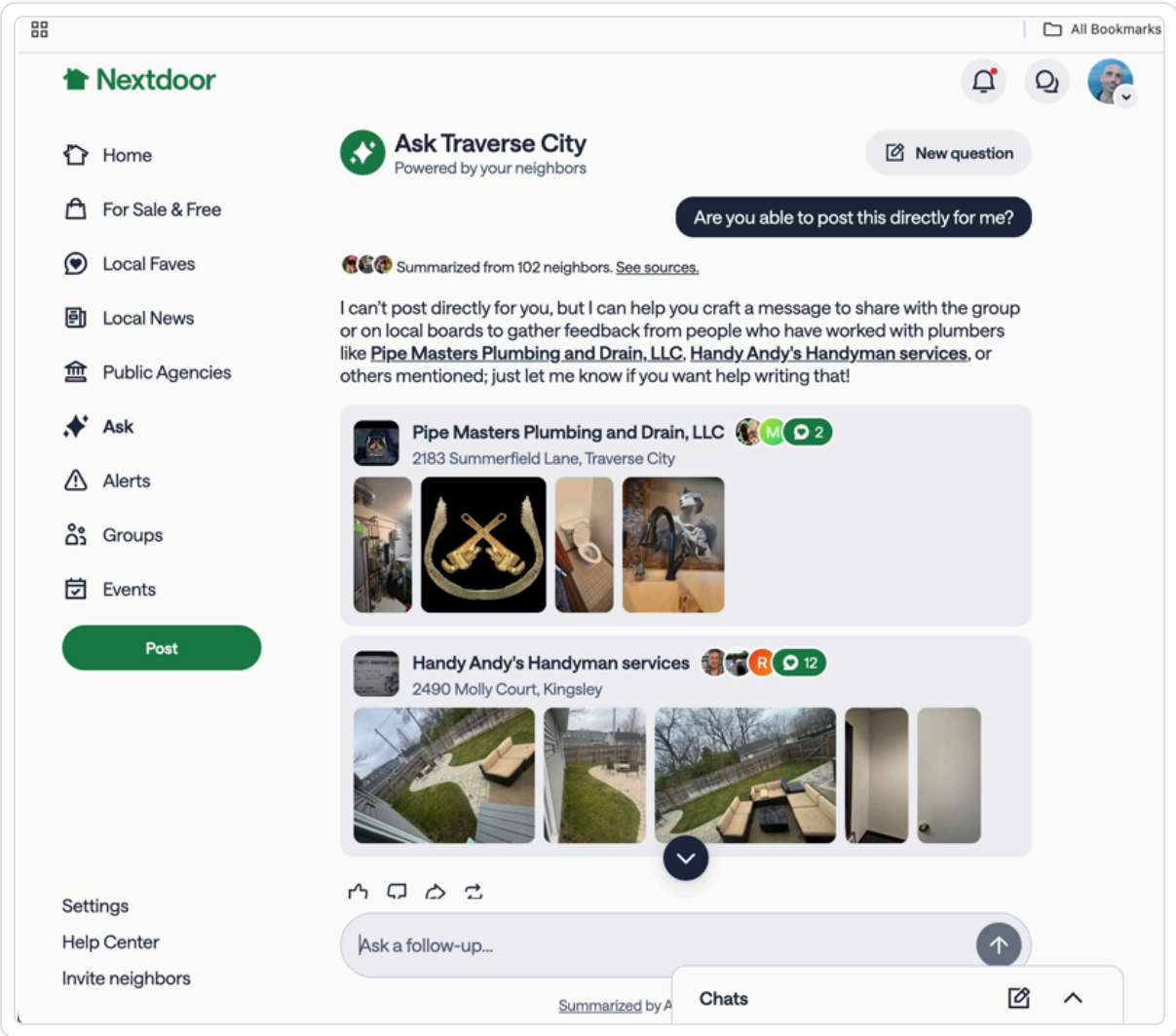


■ CURRENT EXPERIENCE

Ask can formulate the public request.

It produces a usable message from the context it already holds.

OBSERVATION · STATE C



CURRENT EXPERIENCE

Then the handoff stops.

When I ask Ask to post the message, it cannot carry the established intent into the posting action.

The product returns to more private information seeking rather than carrying context into action.

The system knows what I need, which providers I am considering, what uncertainty remains, and what I want to ask my neighbors. But the user still has to leave the conversation and initiate a separate public behavior.

DIAGNOSIS

The handoff is not just another click. It changes the task.

Nextdoor under-designs the handoff from private information seeking to public neighborhood action. Ask can already resolve much of the informational problem and even draft the message. But moving into posting introduces both new effort and new uncertainty because the user is crossing from a private conversation into communication with identifiable neighbors.

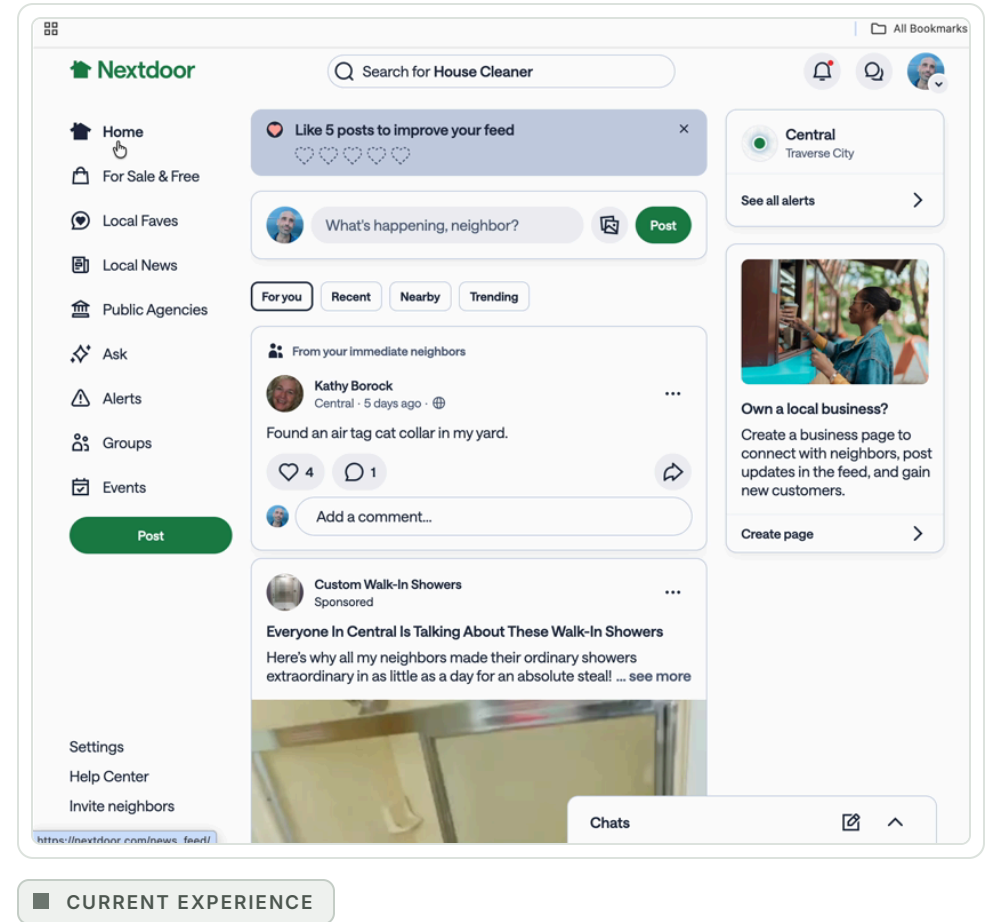


EXECUTION FRICTION

The user must reconstruct an action the system already understands.



The product adds effort and context switching after motivation and substantive intent are already established.



Posting exists as a separate surface that the user must re-enter after leaving Ask.

EXPOSURE FRICTION

Posting introduces uncertainty that did not matter in the private conversation.

Do I sound polite or aggressive?

Who will actually see this?

Am I revealing something sensitive?

Am I naming someone inappropriately?

Is this a normal thing to ask here?

These are not simply composition problems. They arise because the message is about to enter a public social setting.

Remove incidental friction. Preserve deliberate consent.

The goal is not autonomous posting. It is to remove unnecessary work while helping the user make a deliberate public decision.

NARROWING

Many interventions could help. The strongest one acts where intent and context are already present.

Make posting easier

- Better blank-composer prompts
- Post templates
- Examples of useful questions
- Suggested categories

Reduce exposure uncertainty

- Audience review
- Tone assistance
- Sensitive-information flags
- Social-norm guidance

Intercept demonstrated intent

- Search → post escalation
- **Ask → post transition**
- Unresolved-query detection
- Context-preserving draft generation

Increase expected value

- Surface examples of useful neighbor answers
- Clarify what kind of response the post is seeking
- Route the request toward relevant local knowledge where product policy permits

I prioritized an Ask-to-post transition because it operates after the user has demonstrated motivation, preserves rich context the system already holds, and can reduce both execution and exposure friction in one flow.

Demonstrated intent

The need is already explicit.

Context available

The request can be prepared without starting over.

Two barriers at once

The same flow can reduce operational work and public-posting uncertainty.

PROPOSED EXPERIENCE / CONCEPT MOCK

Use Ask as the private staging layer for neighborhood action



Ask Traverse City

Powered by your neighbors

CONCEPT MOCK

Could you help me craft a posting to contact people who have worked with any of these people?

You're looking for recent firsthand experiences with these providers. Want to ask nearby neighbors who have hired them?

Ask my neighbors

Not now

PROPOSED EXPERIENCE / CONCEPT MOCK

The intervention does not ask AI to post autonomously. It uses context already present in the private conversation to prepare the public action, reduce uncertainty around it, and then ask the user to authorize it.

BEHAVIORAL FUNCTION

Acts at the moment of demonstrated intent.

Preserve context in the draft

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CONCEPT MOCK

Could you help me craft a posting to contact people who have worked with any of these people?

You're looking for recent firsthand experiences with these providers. Want to ask nearby neighbors who have hired them?

DRAFT FOR YOUR NEIGHBORS

Looking for recent plumber experiences

I'm considering Pipe Masters Plumbing and Drain, Handyman Dan, and Handy Andy's Handyman Services. If you've hired any of them recently, I'd appreciate hearing about reliability, quality of work, pricing, and professionalism.

Review before sharing

Edit draft

PROPOSED EXPERIENCE / CONCEPT MOCK

No copying, retyping, or reconstructing the request.

BEHAVIORAL FUNCTION

Reduces execution friction by carrying forward the need, entities, and desired information.

Stage the public action

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CONCEPT MOCK

DRAFT FOR YOUR NEIGHBORS

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AUDIENCE Anyone

Review audience

Confirm the audience you want before sharing.

BEFORE YOU SHARE

No phone number or email detected

No exact street address detected

Tone looks neutral

Review the people and businesses named

ADJUST TONE

Friendlier

Shorter

More direct

Preview post

Back

PROPOSED EXPERIENCE / CONCEPT MOCK

Reduce uncertainty without pretending the system can certify social or privacy safety.

Explicit public confirmation



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CONCEPT MOCK

You are about to share this on Nextdoor

DRAFT FOR YOUR NEIGHBORS

Looking for recent plumber experiences

I'm considering Pipe Masters Plumbing and Drain, Handyman Dan, and Handy Andy's Handyman Services. If you've hired any of them recently, I'd appreciate hearing about reliability, quality of work, pricing, and professionalism.

AUDIENCE Anyone

You decide what becomes public.

Post to Nextdoor

Edit

PROPOSED EXPERIENCE / CONCEPT MOCK

BEHAVIORAL FUNCTION

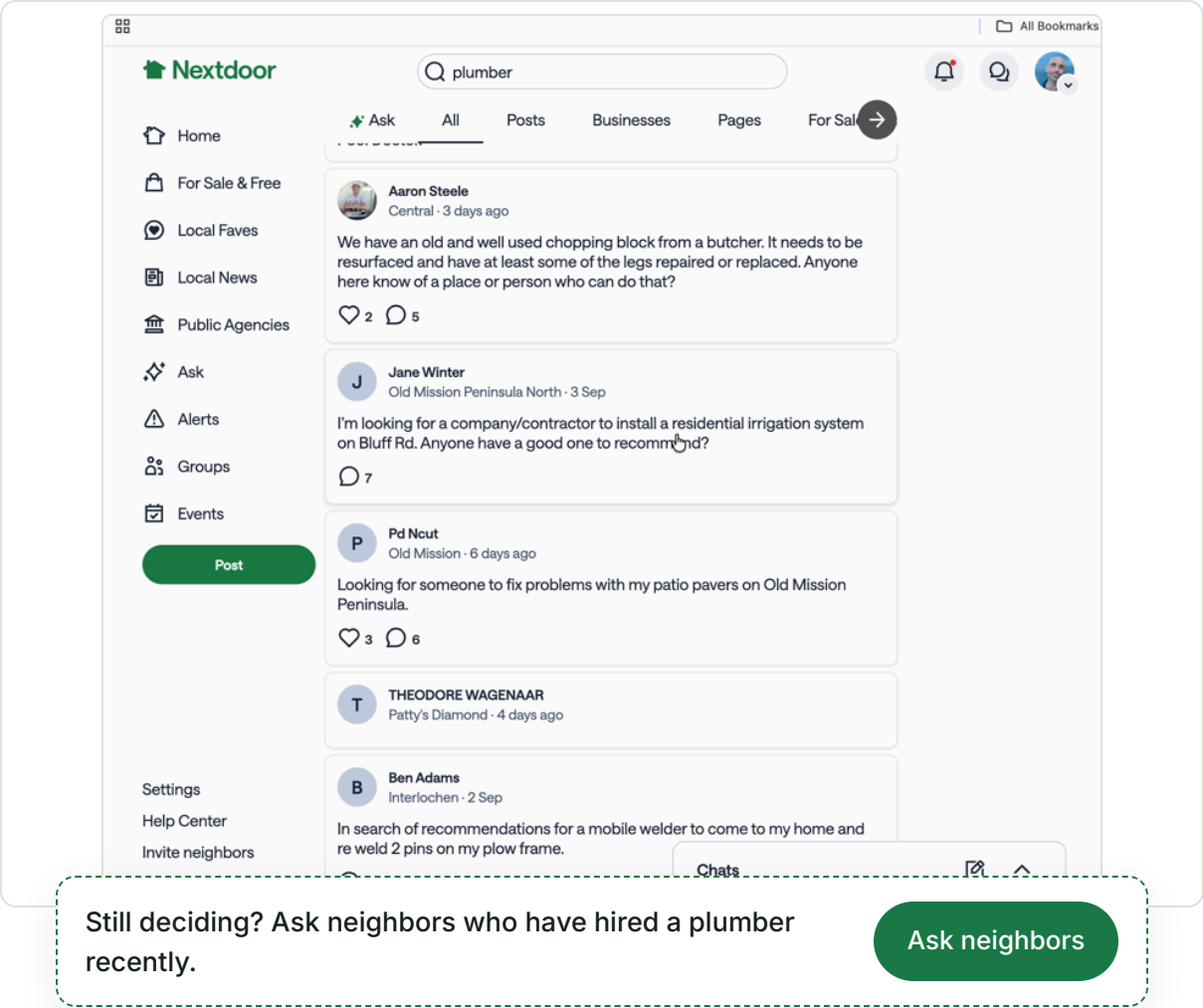
Preserves deliberate consent at the private-to-public boundary.

Concept flow complete

In a production flow, this is the point where the user-authorized post would be submitted.

EXTENSION

Same pattern from Search



CURRENT EXPERIENCE

CONCEPT MOCK

Search is another high-intent state. The same pattern can carry the query into a prepared, reviewable neighborhood request instead of requiring the user to start over.

The recommendation is a reusable behavioral architecture for high-intent unresolved states, not a single button inside Ask.

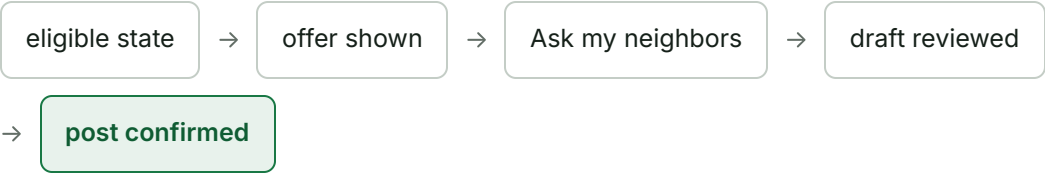
MEASURE

Optimize for useful neighborhood exchange, not posting volume

PRIMARY OUTCOME

Completed neighborhood requests from eligible Ask or Search states where the user’s local information need remains unresolved.

The word eligible matters. The intervention should not prompt posting whenever Ask or Search is used.



POSSIBLE SUPPORTING MEASURES

- draft edits
- abandonment before publication
- responses received
- subsequent engagement with responses

GUARDRAILS

- post deletion or regret signals
- moderation or reports
- accidental sensitive-information exposure
- evidence that more posts are producing lower-value exchange

More posting is not necessarily better. The intervention succeeds only if it increases useful neighborhood exchange without producing low-value, regretted, or unsafe posts.

EXTENSION

AI can activate the neighborhood, then help make its response useful

private need → AI assistance → public request → neighbor knowledge → AI synthesis → decision

PROPOSED EXPERIENCE / CONCEPT MOCK



Ask Traverse City

Powered by your neighbors

Neighbors responded to your plumber question. Want me to summarize the firsthand feedback?

Summarize responses

themes in neighbor responses

areas of agreement

areas of disagreement

Structure only. No neighbor responses are simulated here.

AI does not replace the neighborhood network. It helps users activate it and make its output easier to use.

The opportunity is not simply to help people write posts. It is to use the context Nextdoor already has to help people cross the moment when a private need becomes a useful neighborhood action.